ZHANLI LI（李展利）

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zhanli-li.github.io ◇ Zhanli-Li (200+ stars) ◇ Google Scholar: 37 first-author citations

EDUCATION

Nanjing University *September 2027 – June 2032 (expected)*
School of Artificial Intelligence, Direct Ph.D. in Computer Science and Technology
Group: LAMDA (Head: Zhi-Hua Zhou) **Advisor:** Han-Jia Ye
Research Interests: LLMs, Agentic Training, Document Intelligence, Causal Inference

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law *September 2023 – June 2027*
Wenlan School of Business (Honors College), B.Sc. in Digital Economy
Rank: 2/80 **National Scholarship**

PUBLICATIONS

Zhanli Li, ..., Feng Hong, Zhizhao Zeng, Xunliang Cai, Hanjia Ye. *Data World: Scaling Data Environments from Scratch. Preprint.* [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Huiwen Tian, Lvzhou Luo, Yixuan Cao, Ping Luo. *DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search. arXiv Preprint.* [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Yixuan Cao, Lvzhou Luo, Ping Luo. *Navigating Large-Scale Document Collections: MuDABench for Multi-Document Analytical QA. ACL 2026* (CCF-A). [**First Author**]

Zhanli Li, Zichao Yang. *ESG Rating Disagreement and Corporate Total Factor Productivity: Inference and Prediction. Finance Research Letters*, vol. 78, p. 107127, 2025. (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9). [**First Author**]

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Data World: Scaling Data Environments from Scratch ***First Author*** *May 2026 – Present*
Proposed **Data World**, a multi-agent engine that scales data environments from scratch — **specify the world behind the files before generating them**. From an explicit **causal skeleton**, agent sessions build a canonical state layer by layer and project it into analyst-visible files; an **independent audit** verifies target phenomena remain recoverable. Audited worlds ground analysis tasks with **fine-grained rubrics**, yielding **DataWorld-Bench** and 2,135 world-disjoint training tasks; **RL-zero** training improves the base model by up to **20.9** points on four benchmarks.
▷ **Under Review (ARR Oct)**; single-source validation effective on **LongCat 2.0 Flash**.
Page: https://zhanli-li.github.io/Data-World/ **Code:** https://github.com/Zhanli-Li/Data-World **Data:** https://huggingface.co/collections/Zhanli-Li/dataworld

DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search ***First Author*** *October 2025 – February 2026*
Proposed **DeepRead**, a structure-aware document reasoning agent that preserves layout fidelity via OCR, constructs **paragraph-level coordinates**, and equips LLMs with **Retrieve** and **ReadSection** tools. Unlike flat chunk-based agentic search, DeepRead explicitly models document hierarchy and reading order, allowing the agent to first locate relevant regions and then inspect complete local context. Under our environment setting, this gives rise to human-like "locate-then-read" reading behavior and improves over **Search-o1** style baselines by an average of **10.3%** across four multi-type document benchmarks.
▷ **arXiv Preprint**; reported by **New Wisdom**.
Paper: https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.05014 **Code:** https://github.com/Zhanli-Li/DeepRead
Media: https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/BhvUQgREp4NOvb6axiWXiQ

MuDABench: Multi-Document Analytical QA Benchmark and Multi-Agent Framework ***First Author*** *April 2025 – December 2025*

Constructed **MuDABench**, a multi-document analytical QA benchmark with **80k+ pages**, **332 questions**, and **4,964 structured intermediate facts** that expose failure stages across document selection, extraction, cross-document aggregation, and numerical reasoning over large collections. Designed a **Multi-Agent** workflow that substantially improves over standard retrieval baselines.

▷ **Published in** *ACL 2026 (CCF-A).*

Paper: https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.22239 **Code:** https://github.com/Zhanli-Li/MuDABench **Data:** https://huggingface.co/datasets/Zhanli-Li/MuDABench

SHAP-Based Causal Inference Framework for Corporate Finance ***First Author*** *September 2024 – January 2025*

Built an interpretable machine learning framework combining manually coded panel data and **Optuna** hyperparameter optimization, achieving $R^2 = 0.76$ on corporate total factor productivity prediction. Further used **SHAP** to quantify the **nonlinear marginal contribution** of ESG rating disagreement to outcome variables and reveal potential causal pathways linking heterogeneous ESG signals with productivity outcomes.

▷ **Published in** *Finance Research Letters* (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9); received the Outstanding Paper Award at the Tsinghua Causal Inference Seminar.

Paper: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.frl.2025.107127 **Media:** https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/5oEEnyVM_0PdWTg-7X8RJA

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Meituan LongCat Interaction (Foundation Model Team) *May 2026 – Present*

Role: Research Intern **Mentors:** Feng Hong, Zhizhao Zeng **Model:** https://longcat.chat/

Project: LongCat Work Coding Agent special project — improving the **LongCat** model's performance on a range of **productivity benchmarks** in **post-training**; responsible for capability improvement on **DAComp**, a data analysis benchmark, focusing on **synthesizing harder tasks** to **rejection-sample** better trajectories.

Beijing Paoding Technology Co., Ltd. (AI Startup) — Research Dept. *June 2025 – February 2026*

Role: AI Research Intern **Mentors:** Ping Luo, Yixuan Cao **Product:** https://chatdoc.com/

Project: Improved context retrieval in production-grade RAG systems by optimizing context-missing issues with **PDFlux** and **ChatDOC**; worked on retrieval completeness and document-context preservation for complex financial-document scenarios.

COMPETITION EXPERIENCE

NVIDIA Nemotron Model Reasoning Challenge ***Silver Medal*** *June 2026*

Built an agentic reasoning framework for abstract puzzle solving on **Nemotron-3-Nano-30B-A3B** under the required **LoRA** setting, organizing induced rules into reusable solvers; scored **0.86**, top **2.85%** globally.

HONORS & SERVICE

China National Scholarship *November 2025*

The highest national-level undergraduate scholarship in China.

China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling *November 2025*

First Prize (team leader); led problem formulation, modeling, implementation, and paper writing.

Hunan Province Outstanding Student *April 2023*

Awarded to outstanding high school students in Hunan Province.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

English: CET-4: 522, CET-6: 508 **Libraries & Frameworks:** slime, sglang, ms-swift, vllm, verl, llamaindex, transformers, torch, sklearn, pandas, numpy